CASTLEDERG SURGERY - Flu/Covid Clinics - Tue 20 - Tue 27 October – 2.00pm – 5.00pm. Text messages have been sent for patients to book their appointment or by letter those without a mobile. It is important that you make contact with the surgery on 028 816 71211, Option 3, to book an appointment. If these dates do not suit, you can book an appointment for Newtownstewart Surgery – Wed 21 October, 2.00pm - 5.30pm or Thurs 29 October, 2.00pm to 5.00pm.

IVY'S DANCE – CASTLEDERG COMMITTEE OF CANCER RESEARCH UK: Saturday 31 October, Scraghey Community Centre. Dancing from 9.30pm. Music by Charlie and Claire. Adm £8. Raffle on the night. Light refreshments will be served.

AUTUMN SALE – CASTLEDERG COMMITTEE OF CANCER RESEARCH UK: Saturday 19 – Friday 23 October, 11.00am – 8.00pm, in the Aghyaran Centre. All items of furniture, clothing and bric-a-brac will be gratefully accepted.

DANCE in Garvagh Hall this Friday, 23 October - Music by The Lakelanders - Dancing 9.00 – 12.00midnight. Refreshments served.

A Heartfelt Thank You

Dear friends,

As I prepare to take up my new appointment as Parish Priest of Drumragh (Omagh) on 30th October, I wish to record my deep gratitude to you all for your kindness, support and generosity, both in the life of the parishes and to me personally, for the last seven years. Throughout my seven years of ministry in Aghyaran and Ardstraw West & Castlederg, and three years in Drumquin, I have been supported by wonderful teams of people who have walked with me and, on so many occasions, somehow made the impossible possible! I feel very blessed to have been part of the faith story of the people of the three parishes and, in thanking you for the very significant role you have played in inspiring an encouraging me in my own faith journey, I very much hope that, in some small way, my ministry among you has helped and encouraged you on your own journey of faith.

I could never have managed without the help I have had in the Parochial House, the Office, our churches, our halls, graveyards and our schools. To our parish secretary, newsletter editor, sacristans, caretakers, school staff and volunteers: thank you. You kept everything going, often with little recognition or outward expressions of gratitude. And behind all of our liturgies there lies an 'army' of people – readers, eucharistic ministers, altar servers, musicians/choirs, collectors, counters, cleaners, groundsmen, caretakers – people who just show up faithfully and willingly, week in and week out. Special thanks too to those who have given of their gifts, knowledge and time on parish committees including the various fundraising groups, parish tea group, children's liturgy and, more recently, on our Leadership Teams. I am indebted also to the staff and children of our schools for their warm welcome at all times and their co-operation and willingness to share in the life of our churches and parishes.

I have been privileged to accompany many families and individuals on milestone occasions in their lives over the last seven years. It is always wonderful to share with families in the happy, joyful occasions – the baptisms, weddings, Golden Weddings, First Communions, Confirmations and other achievements. Part of priestly ministry of course is journeying with families in their darkest hours – families facing illness, death and the loss of loved ones, sometimes in the most heartbreaking circumstances. It has been a privilege for me to have walked with many families in sad, difficulty and challenging times in their lives. Again, I have found the faith and courage shown by so many families at such times to be deeply humbling, and a source of strength and reassurance to me in my own faith.

An important part of any priest's ministry is visiting and bringing the Eucharist to those who are housebound or unable to come to church. Visitation of the housebound in our parishes has been a very privileged part of my ministry; so too has visitation of our Nursing Homes.

We came through Covid together, and we've shared seven Christmases and Easters. I won't forget any of this! In recent years it has also been a joy to have Fr Thomas minister alongside me. His generosity and helpfulness have been a great blessing. Thank you, Fr Thomas, for all your support. My thanks too to Fr Gilmore for his wise counsel, and to Fr Peter McCawille for the generous help he continues to give to us all. I leave with a heavy heart, but also with memories of friendship and neighbourliness that, for me, make the Gospel come alive.

Last but not least, I want to say a word of welcome to my successor, Fr Chris. There are a good many projects underway or just about to begin, but Fr Chris is talented, capable and hardworking, and I have no worries on that score. With your help and encouragement, and with his leadership, I know the people of these three parishes will grow stronger in faith and keep the light of the Gospel burning brightly, a beacon of hope in a fragile world. I hope Fr Chris will be as happy here as I have been, and I ask God's blessing on all that you do together.
Please keep me in your thoughts and prayers. I'll always keep the people of this pastoral area in mine, asking that God will reward you for all your goodness and kindness.

With love and gratitude,

Fr Paul

Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick

Twenty-Ninth Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A – 18th October 2026

Parish Clergy: Fr Michael McCaughey, PP: (028) 71882274 / (028) 71882215

Fr Declan Boland (priest in residence)

Email: leckpatrickparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website**: www.leckpatrickparish.com

Email: strabaneparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.camusparish.com

Email: clonleighparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website**: www.clonleighparish.com

Gospel Reflection *(Matthew 22:15-21)*

In today's gospel, religious leaders try to trap Jesus with a question about paying taxes to Caesar. Pointing to the coin's image and inscription, He teaches us to fulfil our earthly responsibilities while giving our deepest allegiance to God. Jesus reminds us that not every question deserves a fight. What matters is whether our choices reflect goodness, truth, and love, drawing us closer to God,

strengthening our character, and blessing others. A life well lived is measured not by arguments won, but by faithfulness to God's will.

The coin carried Caesar's image, reminding us to respect legitimate laws, perform our duties honestly, support our families, and contribute positively to society. Faith does not excuse us from responsible citizenship; it inspires us to fulfil our duties with sincerity and fairness. The coin bore Caesar's image, but our lives are called to reflect God's goodness. Though we cannot do so perfectly every day, we can choose to grow: let our words encourage, our hands help, and our hearts forgive.

We may give money to the world, time to our responsibilities, and attention to our ambitions, but we must give God what belongs to Him: our love, worship, gratitude, trust, and obedience. Our relationship with God remains the foundation of a meaningful life.

We may carry coins in our pockets, but we carry God's calling in our hearts. Give the world your honest service, others your genuine love, and God your whole heart. That is how an ordinary life becomes a beautiful offering to Him.

Today is World Mission Sunday October has been the month of universal mission since 1926. Mission Sunday invites Catholics to unite with missionaries worldwide and recommit to the Church's missionary activity through prayer, sacrifice and financial support. Funds help young churches and missionaries serve communities in need, both spiritually and materially. Contributions build mission churches, educate seminarians, form catechists and lay leaders, fund children's

health clinics, provide emergency aid in war or disaster, and help missionaries care for refugees. This year's theme is 'One in Christ, united in mission'. Today we celebrate our c. 1,500 Irish-born missionaries and all missionaries worldwide, thanking God for them, for those who support them at home, and for our growing communion with them and the communities they serve. To read

Pope Leo's message for World Mission Sunday, please visit MESSAGE-OF-HIS-HOLINESS-POPE-LEO-XIV-for-WMS-2026.pdf

Requiescat in Pace We offer our sympathy of the family and friends of

Martin Gallagher, Guystown, Ballindrait, Lifford

Anniversaries Jean Allen, Martin Blee, Kathleen Coups, Gerry Crawford, Joseph Dunne, Tommy Dunne, Mary Elliott, Mary Alice Elliott, Annie Feeney, Charles Flanagan, Pat McColgan, Willie McCullagh, Daniel Gerald McFadden, Daniel McGllion, Ryan McGonigle, Bridie O'Donnell, Paddy O'Donnell, Paddy O'Kane, Philomena O'Kane, Pat Quinn, Rose Roulston, Gerry Strawbridge. Rest in peace.

9.45am Mass on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

Thank You for your generosity to last week's collections

Leckpatrick £1,204.37

Clonleigh €1,969.94

Camus £1,534.14.

Thanks to those who pay by standing order.

Readings for Sunday 25th October:

1st Reading: Exodus 22:20-26

Psalm: 18:2-3,3-4, 47, 51

2nd Reading: 1 Thessalonians 1:5c-10

Gospel: Matthew 22:34-40

Saints of the Coming Week:

Monday St John de Brebeuf, St Isaac Jogues, priests and companions, martyrs

St Paul of the Cross, priest

Thursday St John Paul II, pope

Friday St John of Capistrano, priest

Saturday St Anthony Mary Claret, bishop

St Patrick's Church, Murlog We wish to remind all parishioners that the **Vigil Mass** at St Patrick's, Murlog is now at **6.00 pm**, until further notification. We thank you all for your cooperation and understanding.

Annual Day of Prayer, Praise and Healing takes place on Sunday 15th November in the Silver Birch Hotel, Omagh. Registration at 9.30 am and concluding with celebration of Mass and Healing Service in the afternoon. Guest speaker is Fr John Keane. Theme: 'People of God's Delight' (Ps 149.4). The day is organised by Omagh Charismatic Prayer Group which celebrates its 50th anniversary. All welcome.

ACCORD Derry Marriage Preparation Courses Dates: 29th/30th January, 19th/20th February & 19th/20th March 2027 are now available to book. Please visit www.accordni.com Courses are in person in Everglades Hotel, Derry.

Class Act Theatre Group presents *Fame, The Musical* at St Patrick's Hall, Strabane, from 2nd – 6th November. This exciting production will showcase the talents of almost 100 local young people, providing a wonderful opportunity for the community to support and celebrate local talent on stage. Audiences can look forward to an energetic and uplifting performance featuring a large cast of dedicated young performers. Given the popularity of previous Class Act productions, early booking is strongly recommended. Tickets can be booked online via the Class Act Theatre Group website: www.classacttheatregroup.co.uk/events

Global Rosary for Peace in the Tradition of Venerable Patrick Peyton Join hundreds of thousands of Catholics praying for peace on Thursday 22nd October at 3 pm (GMT), the Feast of St John Paul the Great. Visit Pray for peace – HCFM to register and to watch live on Thursday.

Fatima Pilgrimage 2027 led by spiritual director, Fr Sean O'Donnell on 5th July 2027. Cost: £950 pps. £100 off if paid in full by 30/11/26. 7 nights full board in Hotel Cinquentenario. Please contact Patricia 07743936548 / Anne 07784953408.

Book of Memories of Father Paddy O'Kane A new book is being planned about well known Derry priest, Fr Paddy O'Kane, who died in 2022. Due for publication next year, it will include memories and stories from those who knew him, alongside selections from his Derry News column. If you have a memory or story to share, author Ciaran O'Neill would be delighted to hear from you. Email: caoneill1971@gmail.com or phone: 07875 904354.

Coffee Morning – St Patrick's NS, Murlog You are invited to a Coffee Morning in the GP room on Monday 19th October anytime between 10 am and 12 noon. This invitation is open to everyone. Call in, enjoy a cuppa and some home baking. All money raised will go towards school funds.

Pray for Vocations What does God want you to be? If you think you may have a vocation to serve as a priest of the Derry Diocese, please contact your local priest or Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan on 028 79386259 / pgoh2111@gmail.com

The Next Diocesan Vocations Holy Hours will take place on Tuesday 20th October, 3rd November & 1st December from 8 – 9 pm, following 7.30 pm Mass in St Columb's Church, Chapel Road, Waterside, Derry. Everyone welcome.

Abide Women's Conference from 20th – 22nd November at Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran. Speakers include Sarah Swafford, Fr Barry Braun, Fr Mark Wharton, Kimberlee WooLing, Danielle Noonan, Nashville Dominicans, etc. Mass will be celebrated by Bishop Fintan Gavin, Cork & Ross diocese. Please visit Abide in His Love at Eventbrite.ie. Registration at https://abide inhislove.eventbrite.com